# SRP Checklist

## D4341 / D4342 - how to secure successful SRP claims every time

Scaling and root planing gets denied more often than almost any other hygiene procedure because the payer is looking for proof that this was treatment, not cleaning. Work through this checklist before the claim leaves your office.

### 1. Confirm the diagnosis is documented

- [ ] Periodontal charting is complete for the quadrants being treated, not just the probing depths.
- [ ] Pocket depths of 5mm or greater are recorded with bleeding on probing and recession.
- [ ] The chart notes whether the disease is localised or generalised and which stage applies.
- [ ] The treating provider's diagnosis is written in the clinical note, not implied by the code.
- [ ] Radiographic evidence of bone loss is attached when the chart alone is borderline.

### 2. Check frequency limits before you bill

- [ ] Verify how many SRP visits per year the plan allows and what date the last one was completed.
- [ ] Confirm whether the plan limits by quadrant, by tooth, or by calendar year.
- [ ] Check if the patient's benefits year differs from the calendar year.
- [ ] If the limit is exhausted, decide in advance whether to appeal or bill the patient, and tell the patient before treatment.

### 3. Pair the right codes with the right notes

- [ ] D4341 is four or more teeth per quadrant, D4342 is one to three teeth. Count before selecting.
- [ ] Do not bundle D4341/D4342 with D1110 on the same date for the same site.
- [ ] If you also placed a local anaesthetic or used an antimicrobial, confirm the payer allows it as a separate line.
- [ ] Narrative references the specific teeth treated and the medical reason they needed treatment.

### 4. Attach the evidence the payer asks for

- [ ] Full periodontal chart showing six points per tooth for the treated quadrants.
- [ ] Pre-operative radiographs where the plan requires them.

- [ ] Post-treatment note describing what was actually removed and how the tissue responded.
- [ ] Copy of the referral or medical note if the SRP was tied to a systemic condition.

## 5. Final pre-submission pass

- [ ] Rendering provider NPI and tax ID match the plan's records for this location.
- [ ] Tooth numbers, surfaces and dates of service are correct on every line.
- [ ] Attachments were transmitted with the claim, not sent separately a week later.
- [ ] Claim is inside the payer's timely filing window.
- [ ] Follow-up date is on the calendar for 14 days out.

**Bottom line:** Denials on SRP are almost always a documentation timing problem: the chart existed, but the payer never saw it with the claim. Send them together.